

1985 GRAND MARSHALL

CLIFFORD M. SHEETS



Cliff first became interested in wrestling when his sons began wrestling in high school. He saw a need for more and better qualified referees, so he became one in 1966. He continued to officiate until 1980, and was invited to ref the Illinois High School State Finals twice in the latter half of the 1970's. He was also an active member at the Rules Interpretation Meetings from 1967 to 1980. During his years as an official, he encouraged and trained a great number of young men, many of which are still officiating throughout the state today.

Living in Central Illinois, Cliff began to see that the quality of wrestling in his area was not nearly high enough to compete with Northern Illinois and the Chicagoland area. So in 1974, he began a Kids Program in Decatur. The first few years were very tough for Cliff and his wrestlers, losing nearly every meet. Then, in 1978, they won their regional and sectional tournaments and placed two wrestlers at the state meet. Since that time, Decatur has won five regional titles, six sectional titles, placed 8th at the state meet twice, and had over 50 state qualifiers, four of which were champs. From its humble beginnings, Cliff transformed Decatur from a doormat for Chicago area teams to a downstate power.

Cliff has also been a big supporter of the high school wrestling programs in the Decatur area. In 1981, he organized and led a successful coalition of local wrestlers and coaches and spoke before the school board when it was attempting to drop wrestling in the Decatur high schools.

For his love and dedication to the sport of wrestling, and the success that he has helped many young men achieve, we are proud to honor Clifford Sheets as Grand Marshall for 1985.

PAST GRAND MARSHALLS

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| 1978 | RON SILVERSTEIN
IKWF Founder, Contributor,
Coach (Des Plaines Apollo), and
Past President (1971-74). | 1981 | BILL WIENKE
IKWF Contributor,
Coach (Plainfield, Indian Trails Jr. High).
KEN KRAFT
IKWF Founder, Contributor,
Coach (Northwestern University),
USWF Past President. |
| 1979 | ARCH RICHOS
IKWF Contributor, Coach (DeKalb Huntley), and
Past President (1975-76) & (1982-84),
Past Vice-President (1971-74) & (1981-82).
LARRY STONITSCH
IKWF Contributor, Coach (Joliet Boy's Club), and
Past President (1977-78). | 1982 | JOE THOLL, SR.
IKWF Contributor, Coach (Orland Park Pioneers). |
| 1980 | TERRY WEBER
IKWF Contributor, Coach (New Lenox/Oakview,
Joliet YMCA, and New Lenox Lions), and
Past Secretary/Treasurer (1971-74),
Historian (1980-84).
RICH HARPER
IKWF Coach (Burbank Panthers), and
Past Secretary/Treasurer (1979). | 1983 | FRED DEXTER
IKWF Contributor, Coach (West Chicago). |
| | | 1984 | RAY & ROY CONRAD
IKWF Coaches, Contributors (Franklin Park). |



THE 1984 STATE CHAMPIONSHIP TEAM VITTUM CATS

BOYS' WRESTLING TEAM DATA

Year	Champion	Coach	Points	Runner-Up	Points	Site
1971	New Lenox	Terry Weber	53	Gemini Jr. High	30	Des Plaines (Apollo Jr. High)
1972*	New Lenox Arbor Park Jr. High	Terry Weber Bob Carlson	24 24	DeKalb/Huntley	21	Des Plaines (Main North H.S.)
1973	Joliet Boy's Club	Larry Stonitsch	52	West Chicago	49	Des Plaines (Main North H.S.)
1974	West Chicago	Fred Dexter	42	Tinley Park	40	Des Plaines (Main North H.S.)
1975*	Oak Forest	Ken Gerdes	42	Joliet Boy's Club West Chicago	37 37	DeKalb (DeKalb H.S.)
1976	Burbank	Rich Harper	46	Oak Forest	41	Mattoon (Mattoon H.S.)
1977	Plainfield	Bill Wienke	164	Savanna	119	East Moline (East Moline H.S.)
1978	Plainfield	Bill Wienke	122½	Joliet YMCA	86	Decatur (McArthur H.S.)
1979	Plainfield	Bill Wienke	146	Joliet YMCA	119	Joliet (Joliet Central H.S.)
1980	Chicago Ridge	Art Evensen	192	Plainfield	139	Decatur (McArthur H.S.)
1981	Burbank	Jim Twohill	195	Chicago Ridge	145	Evanston (McGaw Hall)
1982	Burbank	Jim Twohill	145	Dolton	134	Palatine (Harper College)
1983	Tinley Park	Mike Stuckly	149	Burbank	129	DeKalb (Northern Ill. Univ.)
1984	Vittum Cats	Dennis Laughlin	134	Burbank	128	DeKalb (Northern Ill. Univ.)

*1972 Tie for 1st Place

*1975 Tie for 2nd Place